

Recovery & Sleep Guide

Why Recovery Matters

Muscle adaptation happens during recovery, not during the workout itself - training provides the stimulus, recovery (sleep, nutrition, rest days) provides the adaptation.

Inadequate recovery leads to accumulated fatigue, reduced performance, higher injury risk, and can eventually cause overtraining symptoms (persistent fatigue, mood changes, stalled progress).

Sleep Guidance

Most adults need roughly 7-9 hours of sleep per night for optimal recovery, hormone regulation, and cognitive function.

Consistent sleep/wake times, a cool dark room, and limiting screens/caffeine close to bedtime are commonly cited habits for improving sleep quality.

Sleep deprivation is associated with reduced strength performance, impaired recovery, and increased appetite/calorie intake.

Active Recovery & Rest Days

Active recovery (light walking, easy cycling, mobility work) can promote blood flow and reduce stiffness without adding significant fatigue.

Full rest days allow the nervous system and connective tissues to recover, particularly important around heavy training weeks.

Managing Training Stress

Recovery Tool	Purpose
Deload weeks (every 4-8 weeks)	Reduce accumulated fatigue, allow supercompensation
Adequate protein & calories	Provide raw materials for tissue repair
Stress management (outside training)	High life stress adds to overall recovery demand
Hydration	Supports every physiological recovery process

Signs of Inadequate Recovery

Persistent soreness lasting beyond 4-5 days, declining performance despite consistent effort, poor sleep, irritability, or elevated resting heart rate can all signal a need for more recovery.